

WOODLAND DREAMS SHORT VEST

LME BABY COLLECTION - WOODLAND DREAMS

A short, open-front vest with wooden buttons, knitted to be worn over the Woodland Dreams basisbody. Worked flat from neck to hem, no sleeves, simple shoulder-line shaping and a garter stitch border around the neck, hem and armholes. Seven sizes, from 0-1 to 18-24 months. The vest is an accessory piece, and is knitted in one of the collection's colourful shades: sage green, dusty rose, butter yellow, soft blue, olive or terracotta, as a lovely contrast to the body's calm neutral colours.

By Renate Dahl

Little Montessori Explorers

lmexplorers.com



TIP: Read through the whole pattern and the size chart on page 4 before you start, and knit a 15 x 15 cm gauge swatch to check your tension, before casting on the vest itself. This vest is worked flat throughout, never in the round, since the front stays open from neck to hem.

ABOUT THE WOODLAND DREAMS SHORT VEST

PART OF THE COLLECTION

The short vest is one of six accessory pieces in LME Woodland Dreams, knitted to be worn over the basisbody. Where the body is the quiet, neutral foundation, the vest is the colourful layer lifted on top, a simple, open, sleeveless vest, easy to put on and take off, and lovely to combine with the collection's other pieces.

STYLE

Clean lines, a visible button band down the front and a simple garter stitch border around the neck, hem and armholes. No sleeves, no complicated details, just a small, well-fitting vest that adds an extra splash of colour over the body's calm tones.

A ROOMY FIT, MEANT TO GO OVER

The vest is knitted with a little extra width beyond the body's own chest measurement, so it sits nicely on top without pulling tight. It is clearly shorter than the body itself, meant to stop well above the crotch, not cover the whole body, see the size chart for exact measurements and the ratio to the body's own length.

MATERIALS

YARN

Sandnes Garn Alpaka (100% alpaca), or an equivalent yarn with the same gauge. The vest is an accessory piece, so choose one of the collection's colourful shades: sage green, dusty rose, butter yellow, soft blue, olive or terracotta, a lovely contrast to the body's neutral cream, linen, sand, oatmeal or beige.

YARN REQUIREMENTS

Size	Yarn amount
0-1 mnd	40-45 g
1-3 mnd	45-50 g
3-6 mnd	50-60 g
6-9 mnd	60-70 g
9-12 mnd	70-80 g
12-18 mnd	80-90 g
18-24 mnd	90-100 g

NEEDLES AND NOTIONS

Circular needle 4 mm (40 cm is enough, since the vest is worked flat, not in the round). 3-4 small round wooden buttons (see the number for your size in the table on the next page). Stitch markers (at least 2, for the two shoulder lines), a tapestry needle, and a 3 mm crochet hook for crocheting the buttonhole loops, or a sewing needle for worked buttonholes.

SIZE CHART

Finished measurements, measured lying flat. The vest is designed to be worn over the Woodland Dreams basisbody, see the column on the right for how much shorter the vest is than the body in the same size.

Size	Chest width (vest)	Neck opening	Length (vest)	Length (body)
0-1 mnd	49.1 cm	22.0 cm	14.0 cm	25 cm
1-3 mnd	52.7 cm	23.0 cm	15.0 cm	27 cm
3-6 mnd	54.5 cm	24.0 cm	16.5 cm	30 cm
6-9 mnd	58.2 cm	25.0 cm	18.0 cm	33 cm
9-12 mnd	60.0 cm	26.0 cm	20.0 cm	36 cm
12-18 mnd	63.6 cm	27.0 cm	21.5 cm	39 cm
18-24 mnd	65.5 cm	28.0 cm	23.0 cm	42 cm

The chest width is the finished circumference when the vest is buttoned closed at the front, i.e. including the extra width (3 cm more than the body's own chest measurement) that lets the vest sit nicely over the body and a thin layer underneath. The length is calculated as roughly 55% of the body's own neck-to-crotch length in the same size, clearly shorter, as a "short vest" should be.

GAUGE AND DIFFICULTY LEVEL

GAUGE

22 stitches and 30 rows in stockinette stitch = 10 x 10 cm, on 4 mm needles, the same gauge as the basisbody. This gauge is used in every calculation in the pattern. Always knit a swatch first: cast on 26 stitches, work stockinette stitch for approx. 12 cm, bind off and block lightly. If your gauge does not match, change to a smaller or larger needle until it does, not just to match the yarn.

DIFFICULTY LEVEL

Easy to medium, simpler than the basisbody. The vest is worked flat throughout, with no rounds and no raglan sleeves. You should be comfortable increasing and decreasing, picking up stitches along an edge, and working simple buttonholes.

ABBREVIATIONS

Norwegian knitting terms with the English terms alongside.

Norwegian	English	Meaning
r	K	rett
vr	P	vrangbord/vrang
m	st(s)	maske(r)
rad	row	rad
øk	inc	øk (ta opp én tilleggsmaske)
felle	dec	felle (strikk to masker sammen)
fell av	BO	fell av / bind off
legg opp	CO	legg opp masker
ta opp m	pick up sts	ta opp masker langs en kant
matstrikk	garter st	strikk rett på alle rader, begge sider
glattstrikk	St st	rett på retten, vrang på vrangen
RS/VS	RS/WS	rettside/vrangside
rundpinne	circular needle	rundpinne (brukes flatt her)
maskemarkør	st marker	maskemarkør
knapphull	buttonhole	knapphull

TIPS

- The vest is worked flat throughout, never in the round. Turn your work at the end of every row, exactly as you are used to from ordinary flat knitting.
- Use two stitch markers for the two shoulder lines, it makes it much easier to keep track of where the increases should happen.
- Count your stitches at every checkpoint in the tables. It is easier to fix a mistake 10 rows back than 40.

HOW THE VEST IS CONSTRUCTED

The vest is knitted top-down, flat in one piece, with no sleeves. Five simple parts, in this order:

1. The neck edge

Cast on flat at the neck, work a few rows of garter stitch.

3. Divide for the armholes

Bind off a few stitches on each side for the armholes, dividing into front-left, back and front-right.

5. The button band

Work/pick up a garter stitch band along both front edges, with buttonholes on one side.

2. Shoulder-line shaping

Increase evenly along two shoulder lines (front-back and back-front) until the yoke width is reached.

4. Down to the hem

Knit each of the three panels straight down, finishing all with garter stitch at the hem.

PART 1: THE NECK EDGE

The vest is cast on at the neck and knitted flat, top-down, the whole way, since the front stays open from neck to hem. Work the first few rows in garter stitch before switching to stockinette stitch and starting the shoulder shaping.

Example, 0-1 months: Cast on 44 stitches flat on a 4 mm circular needle (you work back and forth, not in the round, throughout the whole vest). Work 4 rows of garter stitch (knit every row). On the last garter row, place a stitch marker after stitch 11 (the boundary between front-left and back), and another stitch marker after stitch 33 (the boundary between back and front-right).

The exact stitch count for your size is in the grading table on the next page.

PART 2: SHOULDER-LINE SHAPING

Switch to stockinette stitch. Now increase evenly along the two shoulder lines, until the yoke width is reached. The vest has no sleeves, so there are only two shoulder lines to increase along, not four raglan lines like on the basisbody. The construction is the same for every size, only the numbers change, see the grading table below.

Increase row (every 2nd row, always on the right side): increase 2 stitches right before and 2 stitches right after each of the two shoulder markers (8 stitches increased in total per increase row, because with only two lines instead of four, each line needs to increase a little faster to reach the same yoke width in the same number of rows). Knit plain stockinette, with no increases, on the row in between. Front-left therefore only increases along its one inner edge (the front stays straight along the button band edge itself), while the back increases along both of its edges.

Size	Neck cast-on	Increase rows	Rows to yoke depth	Sts at yoke depth
0-1 mnd	44	11	26	132
1-3 mnd	52	11	26	140
3-6 mnd	56	11	26	144
6-9 mnd	52	13	30	156
9-12 mnd	56	13	30	160
12-18 mnd	56	14	32	168
18-24 mnd	64	14	32	176

Check: count your stitches. They should match the number in the "Sts at yoke depth" column for your size ("Rows to yoke depth" includes the 4 rows of garter stitch at the neck from part 1). If it does not match, count again before moving on to part 3.

PART 3: DIVIDE FOR THE ARMHOLES

Now the yoke is divided into three parts: front-left, back and front-right, with a small armhole bound off on each side. Do this the same way for every size, use your own row's stitch numbers from the table on the previous page.

Example with numbers for 0-1 months, use your own numbers from the table on the previous page.

- Knit across the 11 front-left stitches (the stitches from the edge to the left shoulder marker).
- Bind off 12 stitches for the armhole (these stitches sit right at the underarm).
- Knit across the 22 back stitches (between the two shoulder markers, minus the stitches just bound off).
- Bind off 12 stitches for the second armhole.
- Knit across the remaining stitches for front-right.
- You now have three separate panels on the needle: front-left and front-right with 27 stitches each, and back with 54 stitches. From here on each panel is worked separately, flat, with its own ball or strand of yarn, straight down to the hem.

The stitches bound off on each side are split evenly: half are counted from the front panel, half from the back panel, right where they meet at the shoulder marker. This is why front-left/front-right goes from 33 stitches (at yoke depth) down to 27 stitches (after dividing), and back goes from 66 stitches down to 54 stitches, see the grading table on the next page for your own size.

PART 4: THE PANELS DOWN TO THE HEM

Knit stockinette stitch straight down on each of the three panels, with no increasing or decreasing, until the vest reaches the desired length. See the table below for how many rows to work for your size.

Size	Rows stockinette	Rows garter at hem	Finished length
0-1 mnd	10	6	14.0 cm
1-3 mnd	13	6	15.0 cm
3-6 mnd	18	6	16.5 cm
6-9 mnd	18	6	18.0 cm
9-12 mnd	24	6	20.0 cm
12-18 mnd	27	6	21.5 cm
18-24 mnd	31	6	23.0 cm

Switch to garter stitch (knit every row) and work 6 rows. Bind off all stitches loosely. Repeat the same way for the other two panels. All three panels should have exactly the same number of rows, so the hem is even all the way around once the panels are sewn together.

PART 5: THE BUTTON BAND AND BUTTONHOLES

Finally, work a simple garter stitch band along both straight front edges, with buttonholes on one side.

Example with numbers for 0-1 months, use your own numbers from the table on page 4 and the grading table on page 9.

- 1 Pick up approx. 32 stitches along the whole front edge, from the hem up to the neck, with the right side facing you. Use the rule of thumb "pick up approx. 3 stitches for every 4 rows" as a starting point, adjust slightly if the edge draws in or ripples.
- 2 Work garter stitch (knit every row) for 4-5 rows.
- 3 On the buttonhole side (right front for girls, left front for boys, or whichever side suits best): on row 2, work 3 buttonholes, evenly spaced along the edge (bind off 2 stitches for each buttonhole, cast on 2 new stitches over the gap on the next row).
- 4 Bind off all stitches loosely in garter stitch. Repeat on the other front edge, with no buttonholes.
- 5 Sew 3 wooden buttons onto the button side, directly opposite each buttonhole.

The number of buttons and how many stitches you pick up along the front edge increase with the size, see the table on page 4 and the stitch counts in the grading table on page 9 (the same row count is used to calculate the front edge pickup). Space the buttons evenly: the first and last button approx. 1.5 cm from the neck and hem, the rest evenly spaced between.

THE ARMHOLE EDGE

The armhole gets the same simple garter stitch border as the rest of the vest, so it doesn't curl and sits nicely around the body's own sleeve underneath.

Pick up stitches all the way around the armhole (along the bound-off edge at the bottom and the two straight sides up towards the shoulder) with the right side facing you, approx. 46 stitches in total for your size (see the table below). Work 3-4 rows of garter stitch. Bind off loosely. Repeat the same way for the other armhole.

Size	Sts bound off at armhole	Pick up approx. (all around)	Body's own sleeve circumf.
0-1 mnd	12	46	8.6 cm
1-3 mnd	12	46	9.1 cm
3-6 mnd	12	46	9.5 cm
6-9 mnd	14	54	10.0 cm
9-12 mnd	14	54	10.5 cm
12-18 mnd	14	56	10.9 cm
18-24 mnd	16	58	11.4 cm

The stitches bound off at the armhole make up 57-64% of the body's own sleeve circumference at the same point (see the table), just enough for the body's sleeve to fit through comfortably along with the yoke above, without the armhole being unnecessarily large. The armhole is an opening, not a tube, so it does not need to fit the whole sleeve circumference.

FINISHING

- 1 Sew the two shoulder seams: place front-left and back, and front-right and back, right sides together, and sew a neat seam along the shoulder line (where the shoulder markers sat during part 2).
- 2 Pick up and work the garter stitch border around both armholes, see the previous page.
- 3 Pick up and work the button band with buttonholes along one front edge, and a plain garter band with no holes along the other, see part 5.
- 4 Sew the buttons on directly opposite the buttonholes.
- 5 Weave in all loose ends securely on the wrong side, and trim them short.
- 6 Lightly steam-block the vest on the wrong side, avoid pressing directly on the garter stitch borders, they should keep their neat, non-curling structure.
- 7 Finally, check that every button is securely attached, and that no loose threads or stitches can come undone.

SAFETY AND CARE

SAFETY

- Always use small, securely attached buttons, and sew them on with double thread, several times through each hole.
- Check the buttons regularly, especially after washing, and reattach them at the first sign of looseness.
- This pattern is not intended for children who put small objects in their mouth unsupervised, never leave a baby alone and unsupervised in the vest during the first while of wearing it.
- All measurements and stitch counts in this pattern are calculated for a roomy, comfortable fit, not a tight safety fit, always follow current safety recommendations for children's clothing.

CARE INSTRUCTIONS

Hand wash gently in lukewarm water with wool wash, or machine wash on a wool cycle at 30 degrees. Press out the water, ease into shape, and dry lying flat on a towel. Avoid hanging the vest up to dry, alpaca can stretch out of shape.

ALL DONE!

Congratulations, your short vest is finished! Put it on over the basisbody, button it closed at the front, and you have a whole colourful layer ready, a lovely part of the entire "Woodland Dreams" collection.

THE REST OF THE COLLECTION

- Basisbody, the neutral foundation the vest is meant to be worn over.
- Lace collar, a loose collar that fastens at the back.
- Ruffle collar, the same fastening, a little more romantic.
- Peter Pan collar, a classic rounded collar.
- Bib, tied with an i-cord or a button.
- I-cord suspenders, the collection's signature piece, adjustable and crossing at the back.
- Woodland Fluffy Skirt, a crocheted skirt made to match the body.

COPYRIGHT

(c) Renate Dahl, Little Montessori Explorers. This pattern is a fully original LME design. You are welcome to sell finished garments you make from this pattern, on a small personal scale, provided the finished product is checked against current safety requirements. The pattern itself, its text and images, may not be shared, copied or resold.

By Renate Dahl · Little Montessori Explorers · lmeexplorers.com